

119 Make a wind vane

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MINS

A wind vane faces into the wind—not toward the direction it's going. Track changing wind patterns with this wind vane. Attach colored clothespins to make a compass and chart the exact wind direction.

What you need

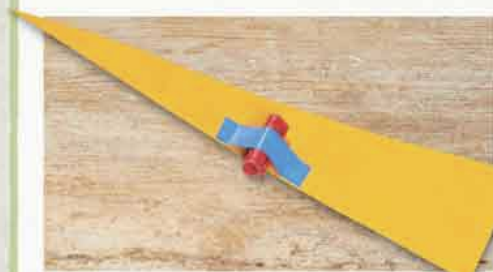
- Letter-sized sheet of posterboard
- Tape
- Scissors
- 2 pennies
- Pen cap
- Skewer
- Stake
- 4 clothespins



1 Fold the posterboard in half lengthwise. Draw from the bottom corner to the top center fold and cut through both layers.



2 Tape the pennies inside near the tip. These will help to balance the vane when it's complete. Tape the vane shut.



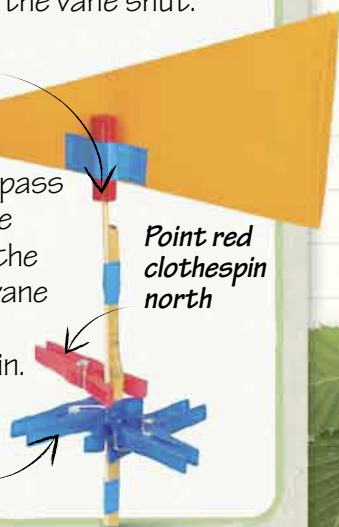
3 Balance the vane on a pencil to find the balance point. Mark this point and tape the pen cap to it. Tape the skewer to the stake. Push it into the ground.

Pivot point

4 Use a compass to align the clothespins on the stake. Put the vane on the skewer and watch it spin.

Point red clothespin north

Each matches a compass point



120 Time thunder and lightning

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MIN

When you see lightning flash, count the seconds until you hear thunder. Sound travels a mile every 5 seconds, or a kilometer every 3, so you can calculate how close the lightning strike was.

